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Financial reports and audited financial statements, and reports of the Board of Auditors: United Nations peacekeeping operations

Administrative and budgetary aspects of the financing of the United Nations peacekeeping operations

Implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2020

Report of the Secretary-General

Summary

The present report provides information in response to the recommendations of the Board of Auditors contained in its report on United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period from 1 July 2019 to 30 June 2020 ([A/75/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II). The report is submitted in accordance with paragraph 7 of General Assembly resolution [48/216 B](#), in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General, at the same time as the recommendations of the Board of Auditors are submitted to the Assembly, to provide it with his responses and to indicate measures that will be taken to implement those recommendations, with appropriate timetables.

The Administration has concurred with most of the Board's recommendations and its relevant comments have been duly reflected in the report of the Board. The present report provides additional comments from the Administration, where appropriate, and information on the status of implementation, the department responsible, the estimated completion date and the priority for each recommendation contained in the report of the Board. In addition, the report contains updated information on the status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board relating to the prior periods that were reported by the Board, in annex II to its report, as not having been fully implemented.



I. Introduction

1. In its resolution [48/216](#) B, the General Assembly requested the Secretary-General, at the same time as the recommendations of the Board of Auditors are submitted to the Assembly, to provide it with his responses and to indicate measures that will be taken to implement those recommendations, with appropriate timetables. The present report is submitted in response to the recommendations of the Board contained in its report on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2020 ([A/75/5](#) (Vol. II), chap. II).

2. In preparing the present report, account was taken of the provisions of the following documents:

(a) General Assembly resolution [52/212](#) B, in particular paragraphs 2 to 5 thereof, and the note by the Secretary-General transmitting the proposals of the Board for improving the implementation of its recommendations approved by the Assembly ([A/52/753](#), annex);

(b) Paragraph 5 of General Assembly resolution [74/249](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to ensure the full implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors and the related recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions in a prompt and timely manner;

(c) Paragraph 6 of General Assembly resolution [74/249](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to continue to indicate an expected time frame for the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors and the priorities for their implementation, including the office holders to be held accountable and measures taken in that regard;

(d) Paragraph 7 of General Assembly resolution [74/249](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to provide, in his next report on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations, a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of all outstanding recommendations of the Board, the root causes of the recurring issues and the measures to be taken.

3. With regard to prioritization, the Administration noted that the Board had categorized 12 of the 30 recommendations for the period ended 30 June 2020 as “main recommendations”. While all recommendations of the Board will be implemented in a timely manner, the main recommendations are considered to be of the highest priority.

4. The status of implementation of the new recommendations as of February 2021 is summarized in tables 1 and 2.

5. As indicated in table 1, all of the 12 main recommendations issued by the Board remained under implementation as of February 2021. Of those 12 main recommendations, 9 have been targeted for implementation before the end of 2021, 2 for implementation before the end of 2022 and 1 for implementation before the end of 2023.

Table 1
Status of implementation of the main recommendations of the Board of Auditors as of February 2021

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	3	–	–	3	3	–
Department of Operational Support	2	–	–	2	2	–
Department of Peace Operations	1	–	–	1	1	–
African Union-United Nations Hybrid Operation in Darfur	1	–	–	1	1	–
Multiple entities	5	–	–	5	5	–
Total	12	–	–	12	12	–

6. As indicated in table 2, as of February 2021, of the 30 recommendations issued by the Board, 5 were not accepted, closure has been requested for 2, and 23 remained under implementation. Of the 23 recommendations that were under implementation, 16 have been targeted for implementation before the end of 2021, 4 for implementation before the end of 2022 and 3 for implementation before the end of 2023.

Table 2
Status of implementation of all recommendations of the Board of Auditors as of February 2021

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	8	3	–	5	5	–
Department of Operational Support	8	2	1	5	5	–
Department of Peace Operations	1	–	–	1	1	–
African Union-United Nations Hybrid Operation in Darfur	2	–	–	2	2	–
Multiple entities	11	–	1	10	10	–
Total	30	5	2	23	23	–

II. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors

7. The information requested by the General Assembly on the status of implementation of recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the financial period ended 30 June 2020 (A/75/5 (Vol. II), chap. II) is set out below. As indicated in the summary of the present report, most of the Administration's comments have already been included in the report of the Board. Accordingly, additional comments are provided only where deemed necessary.

8. In paragraph 68 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration determine the support account share of after-service health

insurance expenditure on the basis of actual costs incurred within peacekeeping operations.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

9. The Administration has started collecting the actual data on the after-service health insurance costs of retired staff members. With further analysis of the data, the Administration will determine the support account share of the after-service health insurance expenditures.

10. In paragraph 75 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration determine and provide to the actuary the actual health-care cost-sharing between the United Nations and after-service health insurance beneficiaries to appropriately reflect the United Nations cost shares in the next valuation of the after-service health insurance liabilities.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

11. In tandem with its actions on the recommendation in paragraph 68 of the Board's report, the Administration will update the sharing of after-service health insurance costs on the basis of actual data and reflect it in the next actuarial valuation to be undertaken as at 31 December 2021.

12. In paragraph 83 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration reassess other methods, including a workload analysis adapted to its purpose, for determining a more precise apportionment of costs between the regular budget and the peacekeeping budget for funding the departments covered under the new funding model.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Not accepted

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

13. The General Assembly considered the Secretary-General's proposal for a new funding model for the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and the Department of Operational Support ([A/74/761](#)) during the main part of its seventy-fifth session, in 2020. It should be noted that no decision was taken on this matter by the conclusion of the session. The Administration therefore considers that

it is premature to develop additional methods while the existing proposal is still before the Assembly.

14. In paragraph 84 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration propose including all other entities co-financed under the support account in the new funding model.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Not accepted
Priority: Medium
Target date: Not applicable

15. The Administration acknowledges that the issues intended to be solved by the proposed funding model for the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and the Department of Operational Support may also apply to some of the other Secretariat entities funded through both the programme budget and the support account. However, the Administration notes that the General Assembly has not yet taken action on the proposal of the Secretary-General contained in document [A/74/761](#) and considers that it is premature to develop a new proposal while the existing proposal is still before the Assembly.

16. In paragraph 94 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration align its financial report (chap. IV) with International Public Sector Accounting Standards (IPSAS) recommended practice guideline 2 in collaboration with other United Nations entities.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Second quarter of 2021

17. The Administration's comments are reflected in paragraph 95 of the Board's report. In addition, the Administration is working to align its financial report with IPSAS recommended practice guideline 2.

18. In paragraph 104 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration integrate decision-taking based on delegated authorities into administrative systems such as Umoja to the extent possible and, if not feasible, track individual decision-taking in a way that facilitates controls and monitoring.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

19. Umoja workflows will be reviewed and revised, wherever possible without customization, to allow decision makers to make approvals directly in Umoja. Where it is not viable to integrate the decision-making steps into Umoja, the Administration will reinforce the documentation of such decisions and require the attachment of the relevant documentation from such transactions, in order to implement the decisions in Umoja. The Administration is looking into strengthening an existing software solution to make it a standard document management system. With regard to decisions for which the approval can neither be made in Umoja nor documented in Umoja at the stage of implementation, the Administration will look into implementing an alternative solution to create workflows allowing the documenting and tracking of all steps of the decision-making process from the approval to the implementation stages.

20. In paragraph 144 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration stipulate that missions shall evaluate all requests for information and intelligence acquisition lists annually ex post, to support their statement on unmanned aircraft systems demand.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

21. The Administration's comments are reflected in paragraph 145 of the Board's report.

22. In paragraph 153 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include provisions for payment or reimbursement deduction in unmanned aircraft system contracts and letters of assist as a standard.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

23. The Administration considers that this recommendation has already been implemented, as the proportionate rate reductions and/or payment deductions are already included in contracts and letters of assist. The Administration also clarifies that the most recent contracts for unmanned aircraft systems and airborne intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance platforms include multiple performance incentives and remedies that tie payments to the timeliness of deployment and the reliability of the services.

24. In paragraph 154 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include provisions, such as liquidated damages, in unmanned aircraft system contracts as a standard that impose additional financial liabilities on the contractor for not meeting the contractual obligations.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Not accepted

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

25. The Administration notes that the determination as to when and how to use liquidated damages provisions and/or other types of cost-recovery mechanisms in United Nations contracts is complex, and such clauses are not appropriate for all contracts. The inclusion of liquidated damages and/or other types of cost-recovery provisions in any given contract depends on the nature of each transaction and the particular facts and requirements of the Organization. Accordingly, the use of liquidated damages and/or other types of cost-recovery provisions in United Nations contracts should be considered carefully, and any questions about such provisions should be referred to the Office of Legal Affairs for appropriate legal advice.

26. In paragraph 155 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration waive unmanned aircraft systems-related claims, such as liquidated damages, only after officially recorded considerations and authorization by an Assistant Secretary-General.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Not accepted

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

27. The Administration notes that the decision on claims related to unmanned aircraft system contracts, including those relating to liquidated damages, should be based on an appropriate legal review. The Administration also notes that the application of liquidated damages provisions in contracts is discretionary, by virtue of the nature of such provisions and the long-standing practice of the United Nations in that regard. Taking into account the numerous contracts that the Administration concludes and manages on an annual basis, it would not be practicable to have to seek a waiver of a discretionary remedy from a United Nations official at the level of Assistant Secretary-General.

28. In paragraph 159 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration fulfil its own obligations of unmanned aircraft system contracts to be able to claim liquidated damages without being at fault.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

29. The model forms of contracts developed by the Office of Legal Affairs for the purchase of goods, for the acquisition of services and for obtaining both goods and related services stipulate that the United Nations has no obligation to provide any assistance to the contractor providing the goods or performing the services other than

as expressly agreed and set forth in the applicable contract. The United Nations makes no representations as to the availability of any facilities or equipment that may be helpful to or useful for the contractor's performance. Thus, the United Nations model contracts stipulate, in general, that the United Nations contractor is responsible, at its own cost, for providing all necessary personnel, equipment, material and supplies, and for making all arrangements necessary for its performance under the contract. As a legal matter, all contracts signed by representatives of the United Nations must clearly set forth the obligations of each of the parties, in order to ensure clarity under the contract and legal certainty. Notwithstanding the foregoing, if a United Nations contract includes a provision requiring the United Nations to provide some assistance or support to the contractor, then the Organization should ensure that it meets its contractual obligations under the contract.

30. With regard to a certain mission that was mentioned by the Board, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation since the United Nations and the contractor have reached a settlement that is favourable to the United Nations.

31. In paragraph 175 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, together with the missions, obtain an independent analysis by a group of experts of whether the current exclusive partnership of having the Mine Action Service with the United Nations Office for Project Services (UNOPS) is cost-effective and delivering on the missions' mandates and evaluate the benefits of the Mine Action Service implementing a certain share of mine action activities itself, for example, by directly administering third-party agreements through Mine Action Service programme managers in the field.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2022

32. The Administration takes issue with some of the inaccurate findings in the Board's report. In addition to what is noted in paragraph 177 of the report, the Administration provided the Board with evidence of consultations with missions to determine the use of existing Secretariat contracts and mission services and pointed out that the Mine Action Service headquarters does not create an additional layer of administrative costs, as programme support costs are not recovered from the assessed budget allocations. The Administration notes that the Mine Action Service is accountable to the mission leadership, the legislative bodies and voluntary donors, in accordance with the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations, the memorandum of understanding between the Secretariat and UNOPS and relevant delegations of authority. The Administration intends to undertake the recommended independent evaluation: (a) after the memorandum of understanding between the Secretariat and UNOPS has been revised and is under implementation, to establish a new baseline for comparing the delivery model of the Mine Action Service and UNOPS partnership with other such models; (b) when the evaluators can undertake field visits and meet with stakeholders; and (c) after several initiatives currently under way to strengthen the delivery model of the Mine Action Service have had a chance to show their effectiveness.

33. In paragraph 176 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include in the new memorandum of understanding with UNOPS clear stipulations on transparency and the provision of supporting documents,

on the utilization of existing United Nations contracts and structures, on the consequences of non-compliance and on the UNOPS fee structure.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2021

34. A series of expert-level discussions covering various topics, such as the application of the memorandum of understanding, governance, the measurability of performance, monitoring, the fee structure, reporting requirements and assets management, were held during the first half of 2020. Subsequently, discussions were held between senior managers of the Secretariat and UNOPS to deal with areas of the memorandum of understanding requiring revision and to obtain guidance with regard to the revisions. Drafting of the new memorandum of understanding has commenced.

35. In paragraph 189 of its report, the Board recommended that missions establish internal controls to ensure that vacant core function posts are occupied without delay and avoid filling these posts with temporary appointments and assignments, except to bridge recruitment periods.

Departments responsible: All peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

36. Missions have indicated that all necessary measures are being taken to fill vacant posts in line with the Board's recommendation.

37. In paragraph 191 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review posts that have been vacant or filled temporarily for two years or more and propose either their abolishment or their retention, including a clear and detailed justification in the next budget proposal.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Not accepted

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

38. The Administration takes note of the recommendations in paragraphs 189 and 191 of the Board's report. As noted in paragraph 193 of the report, the Administration reiterates that the mechanism recommended in paragraph 191 already exists and is used for each budget cycle. The Administration therefore does not see the point of this recommendation or on what criteria it could be considered by the Board as implemented in the future, owing not only to its ongoing nature, but also to the fact that the recommendation in paragraph 189 has been accepted and is under implementation.

39. In paragraph 202 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the circumstances according to the administrative instruction be given, documented and signed by staff with the appropriate delegated authority before exceptionally extending temporary appointments beyond 364 days.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

40. The Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance is liaising with the Department of Operational Support to provide additional guidance on the provisions of section 14 of the administrative instruction on the administration of temporary appointments ([ST/AI/2010/4/Rev.1](#)). The Department will also develop a template, in which the justification and the appropriate delegated authority are documented, for the entities to use when recording and approving extensions of temporary appointments under the aforementioned dispositions.

41. In paragraph 209 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that temporary appointments do not exceed 729 days.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

42. The Administration will continue to request entities to comply with General Assembly resolution [63/250](#), in which the duration of temporary appointments is limited to 729 days. The policy guidance issued in April 2020, by which heads of entities are granted certain exceptional authorities, including to extend the temporary appointments of currently serving staff members beyond 729 days, aimed at providing legal and administrative protection to the individuals concerned and the Organization, as a temporary measure applicable only during the COVID-19 pandemic period. The guidance clearly indicates that exceptional extension of appointments and contracts under these measures shall be strictly related to the COVID-19 context, for the absolute minimum period necessary and until the circumstances necessitating their use have abated (i.e. until travel restrictions have been lifted and travel out of the duty station is possible). The exceptional authorities expired on 31 July 2020.

43. In paragraph 223 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration assess the share of non-United Nations peacekeeping operations passengers on mission flights and the amount of costs that missions have not recovered; assess the budgetary impact on United Nations peacekeeping operations aircraft and fuel needs; and revise the draft policy on the transportation of non-United Nations peace operations passengers on United Nations peace operations provided aviation assets to impose clear definitions as to when non-United Nations peacekeeping operations passenger travel is essential to implementing a mission's mandate.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, Department of Peace Operations and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

44. The Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance will work with the Department of Peace Operations and the Department of Operational Support to review the draft policy on the transportation of non-United Nations peace operations passengers in consultation with all relevant parties. The Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance will also provide guidance to missions on the cost-recovery aspects of this recommendation.

45. **In paragraph 236 of its report, the Board recommended that the United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in Mali (MINUSMA), the United Nations Organization Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO), the African Union-United Nations Hybrid Operation in Darfur (UNAMID), the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL), the United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei (UNISFA), United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus (UNFICYP), the United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS) and the United Nations Support Office in Somalia (UNSOS) establish and implement a standard operating procedure as prescribed under the weapons and ammunition policy.**

Departments responsible: All peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

46. MONUSCO is in the process of drafting a standard operating procedure on weapons and ammunition management in consultation with the relevant entities.

47. In UNIFIL, an updated standard operating procedure on weapons and ammunition management is under final review by its advisory board on weapons and ammunition.

48. In UNMISS, a comprehensive standard operating procedure on weapons and ammunition management is under development.

49. UNISFA has drafted a standard operating procedure on weapons and ammunition management as prescribed in the weapons and ammunition policy.

50. **In paragraph 237 of its report, the Board recommended that MINUSMA, MONUSCO, UNAMID, the United Nations Disengagement Observer Force (UNDOF), UNIFIL and UNSOS establish a weapons and ammunition advisory board.**

Departments responsible: All peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

51. In MONUSCO, internal consultations between the military and the Mission Support Division are ongoing in order to establish an advisory board on weapons and ammunition.

52. In accordance with the weapons and ammunition policy and the United Nations Manual on Ammunition Management, UNIFIL established a mission-wide advisory board on weapons and ammunition. The advisory board held meetings on 25 November 2020, 6 January 2021 and 12 February 2021.

53. In UNDOF, the advisory board on weapons and ammunition has been established and its first meeting was held on 2 February 2021.

54. In paragraph 252 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration reiterate to troop- and police-contributing countries that contingents store ammunition and explosives in missions according to the rules of the Manual on Police and Procedures concerning the Reimbursement and Control of Contingent-Owned Equipment of Troop/Police Contributors Participating in Peacekeeping Missions and only in a quantity as needed to avoid reimbursable unserviceable ammunition and explosives.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

55. The Administration's comments are reflected in paragraph 253 of the Board's report.

56. In paragraph 266 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include in all memorandums of understanding that troop- and police-contributing countries provide a price list of any ammunition and explosive that they will use/deploy, and that it shall calculate reimbursement for ammunition and explosives solely according to this price list.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

57. The Administration wishes to clarify that the implementation of this recommendation will go beyond the existing framework of the model memorandum of understanding, rates of reimbursement and standards of reimbursement framework, as contained in the Manual on Police and Procedures concerning the Reimbursement and Control of Contingent-Owned Equipment of Troop/Police Contributors

Participating in Peacekeeping Missions. It is stated in paragraph 30 of annex A of chapter 3 of the Manual that “Operational ammunition will be reimbursed upon presentation of a claim by the Government and an operational ammunition expenditure certificate from the mission”. Any change to the existing framework will require the approval of the General Assembly through the Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment, which will convene in 2023. Accordingly, the Administration will submit an issue paper for review by and approval of the Working Group. Once the proposal is approved, the Department of Operational Support will begin to implement the recommendation.

58. In paragraph 268 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration create a database with all the cost rates of any ammunition and explosives coming from this price lists to compare the prices.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

59. The Administration will create a database with the rates of reimbursement made in previous cases of ammunition and explosives claims. On the basis of the data collected, the Administration will submit an issue paper to the 2023 gathering of the Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment for its consideration. Once a decision has been made in the Working Group and endorsed by the General Assembly, the database price will be used as a benchmark for future claims.

60. In paragraph 270 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration define the maximum amount of reimbursement that it pays for ammunition and explosives based on this database.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

61. The implementation of this recommendation will require changes to the current framework of reimbursement. Those changes would require agreement in the Working Group on Contingent-Owned Equipment and approval by the General Assembly. The Administration will submit an issue paper for consideration at the 2023 meeting of the Working Group. Once a decision has been made in the Working Group and endorsed by the Assembly, the Administration will begin to implement the recommendation.

62. In paragraph 275 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide training to staff members responsible to ensure the proper recording of fuel data, and regularly monitor and analyse fuel consumption to identify and investigate irregular fuel consumption.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Third quarter of 2022

63. In accordance with the fuel category management strategy, the development of a training programme is a requirement for the professionalization of staff associated with petroleum, oil and lubricant services. The Department of Operational Support will develop and maintain a training framework and standards for fuel officers and assistants, including on the electronic fuel management system. It should, however, be noted that it is the responsibility of the missions to ensure that all personnel whose duties are associated with petroleum, oil and lubricant services are adequately trained in accordance with the petroleum, oil and lubricant training framework programme.

64. In paragraph 284 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a strategy to increase the energy efficiency of power generators in missions and reduce emissions.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

65. The Administration's comments are reflected in paragraph 285 of the Board's report.

66. In paragraph 291 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration perform a review of the arbitral proceeding of Permanent Court of Arbitration case 2016-40 to identify lessons learned and to ensure that proper processes and controls are in place to avoid recurrence of similar issues.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and African Union-United Nations Hybrid Operation in Darfur

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

67. The Department of Operational Support has instructed missions to conduct performance reviews on a timely basis. Furthermore, the implementation of the electronic rations management system has allowed missions to perform this task in a timely manner. Further enhancements of that system regarding warehousing and quality control are in progress.

68. UNAMID stands ready to provide any support in the review process while noting that, since the Operation is expected to close down sites within the first six months of 2021, it will be able to provide this support only to the extent that it continues to exist and the relevant staff remain on board. In addition, the Operation notes that it has instituted requisite controls and contract evaluation measures with regard to its rations contractor.

69. **In paragraph 309 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish a United Nations occupational safety and health management system that includes COVID-19 measures.**

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2022

70. The United Nations occupational safety and health management system was introduced through the promulgation of [ST/SGB/2018/5](#), which indicated that the system would be implemented in a phased manner. The Administration notes that an occupational safety and health management system requires multiple components for which resources have not been made available for personnel costs, and therefore the full implementation of this recommendation is subject to the availability of resources from Member States.

71. **In paragraph 314 of its report, the Board recommended that UNAMID assess the reasons for the build-up of excessive property, plant and equipment and inventories and for the challenges that UNAMID faced in disposing of assets economically, and report on both issues at the end-of-mission report to prevent their recurrence in other missions.**

Department responsible: African Union-United Nations Hybrid Operation in Darfur

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2021

72. The Operation notes that the unique challenges that contributed to the scenario reported by the Board include: complex processes for the clearance of imports; restrictions and detentions by the host country; drastic changes to the Operation's mandate, that led to a significant reduction in the Operation's footprint; an average distance of over 2,000 km from the seaport to the Operation area; and uncertainty over the Operation's lifespan. Details of all the challenges faced will be included in the end-of-mission report, as recommended.

73. **In paragraph 318 of its report, the Board recommended that UNAMID consider all legal restrictions prior to the handover of assets to third parties and clarify whether any current arrangements violate legal restrictions.**

Department responsible: African Union-United Nations Hybrid Operation in Darfur

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2021

74. The drawdown of the Operation is continuing and, by 30 June 2021, the Operation will have handed over all its sites in Darfur, with the exception of the El Fasher logistics base. The Operation will ensure that all legal restrictions are considered and addressed before the handover of any assets or sites.

III. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the reports of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations for prior financial periods

75. In paragraph 7 of its resolution 74/249 B, the General Assembly requested that the Secretary-General provide, in his next report on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations, a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of all outstanding recommendations of the Board, the root causes of the recurring issues and the measures to be taken. Such explanations have been included in the Administration's detailed comments relating to the relevant recommendations.

76. In annex II to the report of the Board of Auditors for the financial period ended 30 June 2020 (A/75/5 (Vol. II), chap. II), the Board provided a summary of the status of implementation of the 116 extant recommendations issued during the seven prior financial periods up to 30 June 2019. Of the 116 extant recommendations, 42 (36 per cent) were assessed as "Implemented", 52 (45 per cent) as "Under implementation", 7 (6 per cent) as "Not implemented" and 15 (13 per cent) as "Overtaken by events".

77. As at 30 June 2020, the overall status of implementation of all of the Board's recommendations issued since the financial period 2012/13 up until the financial period 2018/19 (that is, the seven prior financial periods) is shown in table 3.

Table 3

Overall status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors from seven prior financial periods up until 30 June 2019

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Financial period</i>	<i>Report symbol</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Fully implemented</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Not implemented</i>	<i>Overtaken by events</i>
2012/13	A/68/5 (Vol. II)	49	48 (98%)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	1 (2%)
2013/14	A/69/5 (Vol. II)	63	58 (92%)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	5 (8%)
2014/15	A/70/5 (Vol. II)	31	26 (84%)	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	5 (16%)
2015/16	A/71/5 (Vol. II)	55	47 (85%)	2 (4%)	0 (0%)	6 (11%)
2016/17	A/72/5 (Vol. II)	75	56 (75%)	11 (15%)	1 (1%)	7 (9%)
2017/18	A/73/5 (Vol. II)	52	22 (42%)	17 (33%)	2 (4%)	11 (21%)
2018/19	A/74/5 (Vol. II)	43	16 (37%)	22 (51%)	4 (9%)	1 (3%)
Total		368	273 (74%)	52 (14%)	7 (2%)	36 (10%)

78. Table 4 provides a detailed analysis of the status of implementation, as of February 2021, of the 59 extant recommendations from the prior periods that had been assessed previously by the Board to be either "Under implementation" or "Not implemented".

Table 4

Status of implementation of the outstanding recommendations of the Board of Auditors from prior periods as of February 2021

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	23	–	6	17	17	–
Department of Operational Support	11	–	2	9	9	–
Department of Peace Operations	7	–	1	6	6	–
United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic	1	–	–	1	1	–
Multiple entities	17	–	4	13	13	–
Total	59	–	13	46	46	–

79. Of the 59 recommendations that were assessed by the Board to be either under implementation or not implemented, the Administration has requested the closure of 13 recommendations. The remaining 46 were under implementation as of February 2021, 45 of which are targeted for implementation before the end of 2021 and 1 for implementation in 2023.

A. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2016 (A/71/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

80. In paragraph 40 of its report, the Board reiterated its recommendation that the Administration review the useful lives of fully depreciated assets that are still in use.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

81. The Task Force on Accounting Standards of the United Nations System Chief Executives Board for Coordination (CEB) has completed the collection of useful life data from all United Nations system entities and has indicated that it will be providing the results of the project in the first quarter of 2021. The project, which was expected to be finalized by the end of 2020, was delayed because of issues experienced by the Task Force during the data collection process. The Administration will use these results to update the existing data on useful life of the assets, where applicable, and to design a policy for managing the fully depreciated assets that are still in use.

82. In paragraph 48 of its report, the Board recommended that the Department of Management and the Department of Field Support settle receivables from United Nations related party entities within 12 months.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	All peacekeeping missions, Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

83. The Administration is increasing its efforts to ensure the settlement of receivables due from United Nations related party entities within the recommended period of 12 months. Some examples include the following:

(a) UNMISS, in collaboration with the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda, is making efforts to ensure the settlement of receivables due from United Nations related party entities within the stipulated 12-month period;

(b) UNISFA is making efforts to settle all receivables within the specified time frame. In addition, the Force is revising its memorandums of understanding with agencies to ensure that services rendered by the Force are paid in advance, thus minimizing the number and amount of receivables;

(c) MONUSCO wishes to clarify that most of its related parties have deployed Umoja and that therefore the Mission is using the sales and distribution module for cost recovery. For the related parties that are not using Umoja, sales orders are raised and the Mission has dedicated finance personnel to follow outstanding receivables that are more than a month old. The finance personnel even visit clients to speed up the recovery and, if necessary, they escalate issues to the Mission's management.

B. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2017 (A/72/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

84. In paragraph 88 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration revise its policy and standard operating procedure on welfare and recreation committees and issue clear guidance in the areas of workplans, compliance reports, cash management and monitoring of revenues.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

85. The standard operating procedure was revised in 2020 and is in the process of getting cleared by senior management.

86. In paragraph 113 of its report, the Board recommended that the Department of Peacekeeping Operations and the Department of Political Affairs be put in charge of determining and keeping updated missions' current aircraft demands within budget limitations, and request missions to draft an air operations concept in close cooperation with the Department of Field Support. This air operations concept should include commercial and military aircraft as

well as unmanned aerial systems. It should be based on the mission concept and the mission support concept as well as the military and the police concepts of operations. The Statements of Unit Requirements derived from the mentioned air operations concepts should be realistic and in accordance with the capabilities of aviation military units of that size. The Department of Field Support should be involved in the Statement of Unit Requirements process.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support, Department of Peace Operations and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

87. The Department of Operational Support is taking the lead in addressing this recommendation and will work closely with the Department of Peace Operations and the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance to address all dimensions of the recommendation.

88. In paragraph 144 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse non-United Nations passenger requirements authorized by Security Council mandates. Non-eligible non-United Nations passengers must not be taken into account when calculating overall air transport capacity need.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Target date: Not applicable

89. This recommendation is similar to the new recommendation in paragraph 223 of the Board's report and the Administration therefore requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board to avoid double-counting.

90. In paragraph 208 of its report, the Board recommended that the Department of Field Support, together with the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, review the objective of the key performance indicators and redefine the indicators to provide an effective management tool.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Second quarter of 2021

91. The next generation of key performance indicator reports is being designed to break down the processes by steps and by actors, while still maintaining the overall end-to-end perspective. This approach will help identify and address bottlenecks in the processes. The Regional Service Centre in Entebbe will share such dashboards with client missions.

92. In paragraph 223 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse the landed costs and implications of the vendor's obligation to deliver goods for the major types of commodities and develop guidance for solicitations regarding the determination of delivery terms/international commercial terms that result in best value for money, taking into account the total costs of goods, including the cost of freight, regardless of whether freight is included in the price of goods or contracted separately.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2021

93. The first draft of the international commercial terms guidance document is available and it is being further reviewed and finalized by stakeholders. The guidance will be promulgated by the second quarter of 2021.

94. In paragraph 229 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide clear guidance on recording the costs of freight forwarding services and terms of agreements in Umoja and link those costs to the procured items.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

95. The target date for the finalization of global freight forwarding contracts is May 2021, following which, the guidance will be finalized by December 2021.

96. In paragraph 308 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, together with the missions and service centres, review the advance purchase policy and evaluate how best prices for peacekeeping operations travel can be achieved.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

97. The Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, in mid-2019, provided data and a prior evaluation of the advance purchase policy based on a sample of mission travel. A review of the data indicated that, on 67 per cent of the routes in the mission data set, the advance purchase of tickets resulted in an average savings of approximately \$240 to the Organization. While some specific routes did indeed see less costly economy class tickets when purchased within the 16-day window, the Administration maintains

the opinion consistent with the industry that, overall, the advance purchase of airline tickets yields savings to the Organization. It is important to note that the practice of advance purchase of air tickets remains an overall industry best practice, with a majority of organizations that have significant travel maintaining such policies. The Administration will continue to monitor industry trends in the area of travel policy and provide relevant information to all travel processing offices to implement airfare monitoring technologies through their contracted travel agencies, which will track ticket prices after issuance and return savings to the Organization should the ticket price drop further prior to departure. Owing to the ongoing nature of this activity and the results of the review that was carried out by the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

98. In paragraph 316 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse how the rules for travel and their implementation in Umoja can be aligned further, taking into account the need to clarify accountabilities.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

99. This recommendation continues to be under implementation. The Administration is gathering more information and engaging in wider consultations with all relevant stakeholders.

100. In paragraph 464 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration consider keeping staff members available until after the liquidation date to finalize outstanding tasks.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

101. The Administration cannot infringe on the rights of staff to apply and be selected for positions, and the current policy framework does not permit the Administration to impose such a measure. However, the Administration considers that it is a managerial matter to ensure that the procedures for mission closure are uninterrupted and that the staff members responsible are available to complete the procedures. As is the current practice, it is a matter for the releasing and receiving entities to negotiate a suitable date of release, in accordance with the administrative instruction on the staff selection system (ST/AI/2010/3, sect. 10). A two-day seminar was convened in February 2020 to capture lessons learned from the closure of the United Nations Mission for Justice Support in Haiti. The seminar was underpinned by the extensive mission closure report drafted by the head of the liquidation team. As a result of the seminar, a number of issue papers were drafted that captured the outcome of the seminar and provided

recommendations for implementation. These included recommendations regarding ways in which the Administration might seek to retain or reinforce staff working on a mission closure. The Administration is refining these recommendations with a view to incorporating them into the next iteration of the guide for senior leadership on field entity closure, expected to be finalized in the second quarter of 2021.

102. In paragraph 497 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, together with MINUSCA, analyse the use of prefabricated buildings to avoid the accommodation of contingents in tents.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

103. The remaining construction of buildings is now scheduled for completion by 30 June 2021.

104. In paragraph 500 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration liaise with UNISFA and ask the Government of the Sudan to permit usage of Athony airfield.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations and United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

105. The Administration has continued to make all possible efforts to obtain permission from the Government of the Sudan to use the Athony airfield. The Under-Secretary-General for Peace Operations again raised the issue of the Athony airfield in his meeting with Sudanese authorities during his trip to the Sudan in October 2020; the issue was also raised in the latest report of the Secretary-General on the situation in Abyei (S/2020/1019) and in the briefing to the Security Council on that theme. The Council, in its resolution 2550 (2020), also referred to the issue of the Athony airfield (para. 8). The Administration considers that it has done everything under its responsibility to implement this recommendation and therefore requests the closure of the recommendation by the Board.

106. In paragraph 510 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration act at a global level to prevent further acts of fraud as a result of manipulating Umoja leave time data.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

107. The Administration has promulgated an administrative instruction on danger pay (ST/AI/2020/6). The implementation of the new danger pay solution, under which staff will be required to indicate their location for each day of the month in order to be paid danger pay, is still being tested and remains on track for release in 2021.

C. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2018 (A/73/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

108. In paragraph 37 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure accountable oversight of the management of material master data to achieve improved and harmonized material master data in the areas of product IDs, units of measurement and material descriptions, with a view to accurately reflecting assets in the financial statements and meeting supply chain requirements.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023

109. The material master transformation project is under implementation. The classification of the United Nations Standard Products and Services Code and the category management hierarchies for all active product IDs is in the process of completion. The next phase will be to define the attributes and characteristics of product IDs according to business objectives.

110. In paragraph 70 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration issue comprehensive guidance on cost recoveries, including with regard to responsibilities, agreements and contractual relationships, budgeting, pricing, recovering costs and processing in Umoja.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

111. The comprehensive policy document is currently being drafted by the Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget with the goal of meeting the new target date of the second quarter of 2021.

112. In paragraph 74 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration issue guidance on the appropriate usage of funds commitments and monitor compliance in that regard.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

113. The Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget has drafted the guidelines on the use of funds commitments and they are expected to be cleared and finalized by the new target date of the second quarter of 2021.

114. In paragraph 83 of its report, the Board recommended that the missions, service centres and Headquarters each prepare a comprehensive risk-control matrix in the area of financial reporting.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

115. The Office of Programme Planning, Finance and Budget has documented the internal controls related to financial reporting through comprehensive risk control matrices. The risk control matrices were provided to the peacekeeping missions and service centres. The peacekeeping missions and service centres customized the referenced risk control matrices to their respective entities by 31 December 2020. The Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

116. In paragraph 142 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration adopt the draft force generation manual without further delay and issue guidelines which cover the entire process of force generation. The Administration should designate an accountable and responsible process owner, define the roles of individual staff, establish mechanisms such as regular staff rotation to address any conflict of interest and regulate the competitive selection of contributing countries.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2021

117. The final version of the revised force generation manual is expected to be signed soon by the Under-Secretary-General for Peace Operations.

118. In paragraph 153 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration implement the force generation process in Umoja.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support, Department of Peace Operations and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

119. As part of incorporating force generation and planning processes into Umoja, work package 2 of the Uniformed Capabilities Management System introduces functionality for uniformed (police and military) strength reporting and reimbursements of personnel costs to troop- and police-contributing countries. The solution has been delivered and is on track to be deployed at Headquarters and in peacekeeping and special political missions. This compliments the previously deployed functionality for Statements of Unit Requirements and memorandums of understandings, enhancements to contingent-owned equipment inspection and verification reporting, and the calculation and claim functionality for contingent-owned equipment and ad hoc reimbursements.

120. In paragraph 183 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the objectives, processes and staff requirements of integrated operational teams, considering the upcoming new peace and security structure.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

121. The implementation of this recommendation and the associated recommendation in paragraph 185 of the Board's report, was delayed to allow the consolidation of significant changes in organizational structures, practices and processes entailed in the Secretary-General's peace and security pillar reform. The objectives, processes and staff requirements of the integrated operational teams are currently under review and will be clarified in interdepartmental guidance that is expected to be completed in 2021.

122. In paragraph 185 of its report, the Board further recommended updating the integrated operational teams policy based on this review.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

123. Please refer to the Administration's comments above in response to the Board's recommendation in paragraph 183 of its report.

124. In paragraph 209 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse the direct and indirect costs associated with the disposal of unserviceable and expired ammunition from troop- and/or police-contributing countries and inform Members States accordingly.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support and Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2021

125. The Administration will undertake a study on contingent-owned equipment to support the continuing efforts to strengthen the management of ammunition. The study, which was delayed because of conflicting priorities and the ongoing pandemic, will be carried out by an integrated team of staff from relevant offices in the Department of Peace Operations and the Department of Operational Support. The objective of the study is to conduct a comprehensive review of the status of implementation of recommendations relating to weapons and ammunition management and the United Nations Manual on Ammunition Management; to identify shortcomings that could pose a risk to the safety and security of personnel and property or negatively impact operational readiness and mandate implementation; and to make practical recommendations to strengthen ammunition management in field missions.

126. In paragraph 217 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a comprehensive review of the Operational Ammunition Expenditure Certificates process, with due regard to controls ensuring accuracy, and subsequently rectify deficiencies identified.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2021

127. The Life Support and Transport Section of the Sourcing Support Service of the Logistics Division developed and implemented a new database in Microsoft SharePoint to store and share all information related to claims for ammunition and explosives reimbursement. The database is organized by field mission, troop-contributing country and claim number. The Administration will provide the Board with additional information to enable the closure of this recommendation.

128. In paragraph 226 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish a compliance control to ensure that its contingent-owned equipment inspectors properly conduct arrival inspections for ammunition and explosives, as specified in the guidelines for the field verification and control of contingent-owned equipment and management of memorandum of understanding.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

129. A strategic study on the status of ammunition management in peace operations has commenced and its findings will inform the improvements and corrective actions. Following the study, instructions will be formulated and communicated to the peace operations.

130. In paragraph 227 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review all inventories of ammunition and explosives held by military/police units in missions for compliance with the guidelines for the field verification and control of contingent-owned equipment and management of memorandum of understanding, and update missing information in particular on the date of expiration.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support and Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

131. The United Nations Manual on Ammunition Management published in January 2020 and shared with all missions is the overarching document on the management of ammunition and explosives. The joint code cable to missions dated 27 April 2020 requested all field missions to calculate the operational ammunition requirements against the scales and shelf lives set out in the Manual on Ammunition Management, review the existing inventories and take the requisite actions. The Administration will follow up with the missions to confirm that the relevant actions have been taken.

132. In paragraph 254 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop guidance for missions regarding standardized internal controls, verification procedures and related tests to be performed by each mission stakeholder to ensure accurate troop-strength reporting and subsequently monitor the actual implementation in all missions.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

133. Work package 2 of the Uniformed Capabilities Management System, which introduces functionality for uniformed (police and military) strength reporting and reimbursements of troop costs to troop- and police-contributing countries, has been delivered. The implementation of the solution will also include any required business guidance prepared by business entities. The implementation of the troop- and police-strength reporting process using the Uniformed Capabilities Management System is anticipated to commence with strength reporting by missions, and with

reimbursement processing in the second quarter of 2021. As part of the implementation of the solution, missions have been requested to prepare implementation readiness plans that specify military and police focal points responsible for entering strength data and civilian focal points responsible for reviewing and maintaining process stability within the Uniformed Capabilities Management System.

134. In paragraph 297 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration take stock of its policy framework and business processes, and analyse how these can be aligned and simplified to improve transparency and accountability. The Administration should use the SAP software's standard functionalities to the best possible extent and avoid customizing Umoja.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

135. The comprehensive policy simplification process will continue as one of the core functions of the Office of Human Resources, with a focus on prioritizing strategic and transformational policy development and revision. The Umoja solution supports the implementation of policies and customization of standard SAP functionalities is undertaken as required. Any customization reflects the principle mandated by the General Assembly, summarized in the report of the Secretary-General on enterprise systems for the United Nations Secretariat worldwide ([A/62/510/Rev.1](#), para. 22 (c)): "Customization of the enterprise resource planning software should be kept to a minimum, to avoid unnecessary costs". Considering the broad and ongoing nature of this recommendation, the Administration requests its closure by the Board.

136. In paragraph 335 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration guide and oversee mission implementation of the instructions on property management, and take action in case of non-compliance. This includes ensuring the alignment of functions, Umoja roles and (sub)delegations of authority, and the appropriate composition of the Local Property Survey Board.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2021

137. Regarding the part of the recommendation relating to the monitoring of the property management subdelegations of authority within entities, the Business Transformation and Accountability Division has included in the expanded set of key performance indicators an indicator to ensure that the subdelegations are issued only to qualified United Nations officials. The expanded set of key performance indicators will be rolled out in 2021.

138. Regarding the part of the recommendation relating to the Local Property Survey Boards, the Headquarters Property Survey Board continues to work on the

development of an administrative instruction for property survey boards which will define the purpose, role, functions and composition of Local Property Survey Boards, as well as the monitoring of those Boards by the Headquarters Property Survey Board. The establishment of the monitoring mechanism will be aligned with the release of the related administrative instruction.

139. In paragraph 360 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review its vendor management, with due regard to good common industry standards, and subsequently assign clear responsibilities for the prioritized rectification of deficiencies identified.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

140. Negative reports arising from the contract performance reporting tool have been provided to all vendor management staff, including those in the secretariat of the Vendor Review Committee. In consultation with the Procurement Division, the Vendor Review Committee secretariat determines whether the case should be submitted to the Vendor Review Committee for review. The United Nations Procurement Manual addresses the evaluation of vendor performance, assigning clear roles and responsibilities to the stakeholders in the process. An instant feedback system will greatly assist the vendor management process. The Administration has started to review the financial situation of all vendors that have contracts with the Secretariat valued at more than \$10 million. The new target date for the implementation of this recommendation is the second quarter of 2021.

141. In paragraph 375 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration consider publishing tenders for goods and services instead of solely publishing the request for expression of interest.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

142. The Administration is currently designing and implementing an e-tendering solution. As part of the design work, a dedicated vendor portal is required to allow the United Nations to manage its own vendor community. A technical analysis of the risks of publishing all tenders cannot be undertaken until the portal has been built. The new target date for the implementation of this recommendation is the fourth quarter of 2021.

143. In paragraph 407 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration amend the policy for rosters with the objective to facilitate roster-building, management and data cleansing.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

144. The issue of the staff selection system, including rosters, is currently under discussion in the Staff-Management Committee. Following those discussions, changes to the policy and operational matters related to roster management and data cleansing will be addressed.

145. In paragraph 417 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the recruitment process to increase transparency and simplify and shorten the procedure.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

146. The Administration has undertaken a comprehensive review of the recruitment process and is progressively implementing process improvements. As this is an ongoing process, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

D. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2019 (A/74/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

147. In paragraph 49 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration correct erroneous staff service and participation data which it has already forwarded to the actuary for the valuation of the after-service health insurance liability, and correct the employee benefits liabilities in the financial statements.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

148. The recommended task includes several phases, such as improving the Secretariat's own data, as well as using data received from other United Nations system organizations on the participation of staff in health plans prior to employment with the Secretariat. The first phase is being implemented with the assistance of Umoja. The second phase is being implemented under the auspices of the CEB Task Force on Accounting Standards, which created a working group, of which the

Secretariat is a member, to collect the system-wide data. The goal is to have this improved, in a format acceptable for the actuaries, in time for the next full valuation as at 31 December 2021.

149. In paragraph 57 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen internal controls to prevent potential fraud related to reimbursements for residential security measures, and scrutinize security companies as well as pricing of security services.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2021

150. The Administration documented the internal controls related to reimbursements for residential security measures and provided them to the peacekeeping missions for implementation. The progress on the implementation of the controls will be updated by 31 March 2021.

151. In paragraph 70 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration prevent incorrect settling-in and relocation grant payments by establishing internal controls, especially with regard to the duration of the respective assignments.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: First quarter of 2021

152. The Administration has documented the internal controls related to the settling-in and relocation grants and has provided them to the peacekeeping missions for implementation. The progress on the implementation of the controls will be updated by 31 March 2021.

153. In paragraph 77 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration change the danger pay allowance process to ensure that every absence of staff leads to a danger pay adjustment.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

154. The Administration promulgated the administrative instruction [ST/AI/2020/6](#) in October 2020 for the purpose of establishing conditions for the administration of danger pay. The implementation of the new danger pay solution in Umoja is still being tested and remains on track for release in 2021.

155. In paragraph 83 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen internal controls to ensure appropriate dependency allowance payments by using Umoja and United Nations systems-wide data.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

156. The 2018 and 2019 annual declaration exercises have been completed. The 2020 annual declaration exercise will be executed in early 2021. The Administration wishes to reiterate that all staff members who claim dependency benefits are required to confirm the employment status, including employing organization, of financially dependent spouses. The Administration can perform monitoring only on the basis of the information that staff members provide. Furthermore, the organization does not have a mechanism to monitor data for spouses employed in organizations that do not use Umoja. There are reporting requirements documented for the identification of staff members married to other staff members in the United Nations common system as well as to check whether the same dependent is present under any two different staff members. These reports will be addressed with the other Umoja human resources reporting requirements on the basis of prioritization and available resources. It is important to note that these reports will rely solely on Umoja data and the information provided by staff members.

157. In paragraph 109 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration define minimum basic military skills which every United Nations soldier must have before deployment. In addition, it needs to specify which further skills soldiers of different types of units must have. These requirements should apply to all missions and be evaluated according to standardized criteria.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

158. The Administration continues to make progress in the implementation of this recommendation. The remaining military skills for units will be evaluated in 2021. Efforts will be made to include the adaptation and development of military standards for new doctrines, such as the force protection doctrine, and to harmonize the process with the ongoing review of existing military unit manuals, such as for the logistics and signals units. Artillery units are accorded the lowest priority as there are currently no artillery units deployed in the United Nations peacekeeping operations.

159. In paragraph 116 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration give the military performance evaluation task force a higher priority and consequently reallocate posts to it so it can participate in every initial predeployment visit and participate in at least one out of four troop rotation predeployment visits.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

160. Under the support account budget proposal for the period from July 2021 to June 2022, the Department of Peace Operations is proposing to establish the military performance evaluation task force in the Office of Military Affairs, within existing resources, by moving eight seconded military officers currently performing other functions. This requires that the tasks currently performed by those military officers be absorbed by the remaining officers in the Office's respective services and teams. This proposal is deemed to be implementable within the bounds of the Office's current structure and in compliance with relevant resolutions.

161. In paragraph 117 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration consult with troop-contributing countries to reconsider deployment of a unit if the military performance evaluation task force identifies a lack of predefined basic military skills during predeployment visits.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

162. The process for predeployment visits, as recommended by the Board, has in fact been implemented in line with the Integrated Peacekeeping Performance and Accountability Framework and the operational readiness assurance and performance improvement policy. The Administration would also like to note that military units with performance shortfalls identified during a mission are validated during the predeployment visit conducted for the next rotation of the contingent. The focus of this validation is to identify the contingent's readiness for deployment and also to prioritize remediation in collaboration with troop-contributing countries and strategic partners, in line with Security Council resolution [2436 \(2018\)](#), in which the Council requested the Secretary-General to help troop-contributing countries meet United Nations performance standards. Troop-contributing countries have responded positively to recommendations made by the military performance evaluation task force whenever shortfalls of military skills have been identified during predeployment visits. In 2020, one unit with identified shortfalls was not allowed to be deployed until all remedial measures and improvement recommendations had been implemented. As these established processes continue to be maintained, the Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

163. In paragraph 131 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration deploy the maximum possible number of troops to protect civilians when demanded by the mandate.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations and United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

164. The Administration remains concerned about the formulation of this recommendation as it appears to have no specific, measurable and time-bound criteria for its closure. Just as troop deployments are not the only strategic element in the protection of civilians, as has been shown in many years of policy and practice and has been recognized by Member States, patrols are not the only activity by missions that ultimately contribute to the protection of civilians. The Board has not demonstrated the criteria used for its assertion that there were not enough patrols by MINUSCA to protect civilians. The Administration also notes that troops were not underemployed and were used for numerous additional missions, such as convoy escorts, static security missions (the protection of United Nations sites), as well as combat missions. Recent events in the Central African Republic have demonstrated that the operations and activities of uniformed components cannot be dictated simply by the planned outputs in the results-based budgeting framework, as circumstances require operational changes in deployment, posture and activities that will impact the number of anticipated activities, including patrols. Despite travel constraints due to the COVID-19 pandemic, the Department of Peace Operations worked remotely with missions to maintain accurate assessments of the capabilities and capacities of military components and to consider various reconfigurations, including quick reaction and mobility capabilities, the ability to function in relation to the operational environment and the ability to plan and execute all types of military operations in support of the mandate. In the specific case of MINUSCA, the realignment is focused on enhancing the Mission's capacity for the protection of civilians and its reaction capability. Operational capability has been further developed by introducing more mobile methods of operation, with a reduction in the number of positions and the generation of more mobile patrols and quick reaction capacity. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

165. In paragraph 141 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration support missions in ensuring that they have the units and equipment they need.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations and all peacekeeping missions
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

166. The fundamental reality of the United Nations peacekeeping operations is that at a given point in time, not all missions will have all the units or equipment that they need at full capability. Nevertheless, the Administration regularly reviews and amends, as necessary, the Statement of Unit Requirements, which is based on the concept of operations. In addition, there is a regular process for reviewing and adjusting deployments to enhance the capacity to protect civilians. It is also important

to understand that changes in Statements of Unit Requirements to respond to new operational requirements may lead to the acquisition of troop-contributing countries, which takes time. The above processes are further complemented by regular evaluations of units by force commanders, whose summaries are shared with Headquarters for monitoring and intervention, as necessary. Evaluations are also followed by performance improvement plans for the units with performance deficiencies. The performance of these units is closely monitored and, if required, leads to further action, in accordance with the Integrated Peacekeeping Performance and Accountability Framework. The Department of Peace Operations has established a definition of caveats and a quarterly reporting mechanism, streamlined its procedures to deal with instances of caveats and improved its engagement with the troop-contributing countries concerned. As a result, the number of caveats decreased significantly from 12, in 2019, to only 2, in 2020. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

167. In paragraph 167 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a uniformed capabilities management users' manual for missions and provide training.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

168. This recommendation remains under implementation but the planned provision of training has been impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic. The new target date for the implementation of this recommendation is the fourth quarter of 2021.

169. In paragraph 189 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration develop a generic mission strategic planning cell structure, representing key mandate implementation staff and possibly the resident coordinator.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

170. The Administration completed a desk review and survey of planning structures and capacity in all peacekeeping operations. The key findings and recommendations of the desk review and survey were reflected in a comprehensive report, and consultations on the recommendations in the report have started. The new target date for the implementation of this recommendation is the second quarter of 2021.

171. In paragraph 202 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration extend the delegation of authority portal's functionalities to specify and limit subdelegations to ensure that the staff member who receives subdelegations is aware of the scope.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

172. The Administration continues to improve the delegation of authority portal. Owing to the complexity of the enhancements related to this recommendation and to other planned enhancements, it is now expected that the recommendation will be implemented fully by December 2021.

173. In paragraph 216 of its report, the Board recommended that Headquarters and missions conduct a comprehensive review of roles assigned in Umoja to ensure that the Umoja roles provisioned match the latest stipulations of the Umoja roles guide/security liaison officer workbook, the active staff list and the authorities delegated.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

174. In the fourth quarter of 2020, the Administration performed a comprehensive check of Umoja roles missing required delegations of authority for departments that had been established after the reforms, in order to complete the clean-up of the legacy mismatches carried over from previous departments. The Administration will continue to perform checks for any conflicting delegations of authority, as well as for Umoja roles provisioned without corresponding delegations of authority, on a quarterly basis. The Administration will also enhance its monitoring to include checks on personnel with Umoja roles but without active employment contracts and will flag such cases to the relevant United Nations entities.

175. In paragraph 231 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse which data are necessary for the comprehensive monitoring of the exercise of delegated authorities, take stock of how these aspects are currently recorded and identify changes needed.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2021

176. In the fourth quarter of 2020, the Administration finalized its review of an expanded set of key performance indicators that includes both enhancements to existing indicators and 11 new ones. The new expanded set of indicators is expected to be implemented by June 2021.

177. In paragraph 242 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration propose new financing arrangements for peacekeeping support, namely, the departments at Headquarters, the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe (RSCE) and the United Nations Logistics Base at Brindisi, Italy (UNLB), to reflect that UNLB and RSCE are subordinate to the Department of Operational Support, which provides services to the whole Secretariat after the management reform.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

178. The General Assembly considered the Secretary-General's proposal for a new funding model for the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and the Department of Operational Support (A/74/761) during the main part of its seventy-fifth session, in 2020. It should be noted that no decision was taken on this matter by the conclusion of the session. The Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

179. In paragraph 269 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration document the entire recruitment process of temporary appointments in Inspira and Umoja; the documentation should include all necessary data, especially justification of the need for a temporary appointment and the reasons for its extension.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021

180. The Administration wishes to reiterate that all recruitment is conducted in Inspira through job openings. The evaluation of candidates, including a comparative analysis of candidates and recommendations, is captured and stored in the Inspira platform. As part of the existing standard operating procedures, hiring managers are required to comply with the policy framework for the administration of temporary appointments, including with regard to the availability of funding and the provision of proper justification before extending such appointments. The Administration is developing operational guidance on temporary appointments and temporary assignments that highlights the need to include appropriate justification and data.

181. In paragraph 283 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that officials with delegation of authority base their selection decision on an assessment of how and to what extent the applicants' competencies meet the requirements, and record both the comparative analysis and the selection decision in the system.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

182. The Administration reiterates that the evaluation process for applicants for job openings is included in the administrative instruction on the staff selection system (ST/AI/2010/3). Candidates are subject to a competency-based interview. A comparative analysis report is prepared on each of the candidates to assess the applicability of their competencies to the job opening and a report is created and recorded in the Inspira system. The central review bodies review the proposals for the filling of vacancies to ensure that the candidates were evaluated on the basis of the corresponding evaluation criteria and that the applicable procedures were followed. in accordance with the staff selection system. The mechanism is in place and the Administration therefore requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

183. In paragraph 311 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration base its post requirements on a baseline assessment of functions performed and enhance the documentation of approved posts.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

184. The Administration would like to clarify that the assessment of the overall level of staff is factored into the planning and human resources requirements for all budget proposals on an ongoing basis, bearing in mind, in particular, a mission's mandate and concept of operations, as part of the due diligence process during the preparation of the budget report of the Secretary-General. Before proposals for additional posts are made, missions seek to accommodate, whenever possible, the functions envisaged for the posts from within their authorized capacity through the redeployment, reassignment, reclassification or conversion of posts. In the budget reports, information is provided to give an insight into the challenges and context of the missions and an understanding of the main elements leading to the staffing requirements, as part of the planning assumptions and mission support initiatives, as well as the various components under the results-based budgeting frameworks. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

185. In paragraph 345 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish a review and quality control mechanism for procurement, including acquisition, to ensure that procurement is justified in terms of economy and effectiveness, the statement of requirements and technical specifications reflect and do not exceed the actual need, and the evaluation procedure is suited to and the most efficient at identifying the best offer.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Not applicable

186. The Administration established a group to improve and streamline procurement and property management, which will address the quality control mechanism issue that was noted by the Board. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

187. In paragraph 353 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure international competition by soliciting Internet capacity services and by analysing the market and alternative solutions for transponder capacity.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	First quarter of 2021

188. The Administration launched a request for information procurement exercise for satellite capacity to survey the market. On the basis of the responses received from the request for information, the Administration is developing a statement of work to conduct a solicitation process.

189. In paragraph 363 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that, in cases in which air operators fail to meet the financial criteria for registration, the electronic Special Approval Committee take into account the interdependencies between the financial position of the company and the safety of its air operations, document the assessment and its result and limit special approvals to exceptional cases.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2021

190. The Administration is reviewing the technical and financial evaluation criteria for the registration of air operators. Each case in which an air operator fails to meet the financial criteria for registration is being reviewed by the Special Approval Committee on its own merits following a very robust technical evaluation done by the Aviation Safety Section.

191. **In paragraph 364 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration train back-up staff for the joint technical vendor registration of the air operator's registration procedure.**

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Target date: Fourth quarter of 2021

192. The Aviation Safety Section is on track to implement the planned project for a cadre of technical vendor registration personnel.

193. **In paragraph 389 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that heads of field units stay at their posts and remain responsible for the closure of their units.**

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Second quarter of 2021

194. Please refer to the Administration's comments above in response to a similar recommendation by the Board in paragraph 464 of its report for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2017 ([A/72/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II).

195. **In paragraph 390 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that documents on the closure of field units be certified in written form and include all decisions to sell, transfer, gift or donate assets; record the signatures and offices of the recipients of these assets and detail the monetary impact; and conclude a document on lessons learned for further closure of locations.**

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Target date: Second quarter of 2021

196. The Administration continues the quarterly monitoring of key performance indicators to ensure that prompt and ongoing attention is paid to physical verification requirements. During the second quarter of the 2020/21 financial year, the progress made in physical verifications exceeded 50 per cent for all equipment and strategic reserves.

197. **In paragraph 395 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that disposals are compliant with regulation 5.14 of the Financial Regulations and Rules of the United Nations and are authorized.**

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2021

198. The Administration continues to provide support and advice to missions during downsizing and liquidation, including on the application of regulation 5.14.
